

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Denise and Kristi see potential.



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever seen potential in someone? When?
- Think of something that's happened to you. Would you change how you reacted? Why? Why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can claim, mention, request, or point out an idea, thing, or issue in the workplace environment.
- I can express strong opinions related to work and jobs.
- I can stress and unstress information when speaking.





Let's Explore!

Denise and Kristi **call a meeting***. They have a lot to discuss with Marisa.

* "To call a meeting" means to request that a meeting be held.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Denise:** Welcome, Marisa. Thank you for coming in to see us on such short notice. Marisa, this is Kristi. She is helping out on your book.
- Marisa:** Nice to meet you. Thank you guys for being so generous with your time. You said in your e-mail that you had some thoughts on the book.
- Denise:** Indeed. Let me first say that your book is very interesting and extremely important, especially with what's going on with kids in today's technological world. We think you have a diamond in the rough here.
- Marisa:** But?
- Denise:** Marisa. We feel it's a good book, but we have determined that it could be a great book with a different ending.
- Marisa:** An alternative ending?
- Denise:** This book has a lot of potential. Let us provide you with our expertise and assistance. I'm sure that we can come to some agreement.
- Marisa:** Ok. What do you have in mind?
- Denise:** Kristi.
- Kristi:** Marisa. We love the story. It has a marvellous theme and is beautifully written, however the ending doesn't tie together the rest of the story. I feel that if you are able to tie the end of the story back to clues planted in the beginning, it will provide a much more positive result.
- Marisa:** It's not supposed to though. It is supposed to be open for interpretation. I strongly believe that kids would prefer that kind of ending to the familiar cookie-cutter style. In fact, my professor has no doubt that this is the case.
- Kristi:** It's always a good idea to get outside the box and try new ideas, but this book has a chance to garner a wide appeal with young readers and adults. With an alternative ending, we feel that we could sell this book to school boards and their curriculum across the country right now! Marisa, this book is very close! There's no doubt in my mind that this book could be fantastic!
- Marisa:** Denise, you agree with this?
- Denise:** We are absolutely convinced that this is the right direction to go in.
- Marisa:** Ok. I guess I can accept that.
- Kristi:** It's the right decision. Here's what we were thinking.





Let's Practice!

It's time to point out an idea.

*Instructions: Write the correct form of the verbs **think** and **feel** to correctly complete the sentences.*

1. She _____ if you are able to tie the end of the story back to the clues planted in the beginning, it will provide a much more positive result.
2. With an alternative ending, I _____ that we could sell this book to school boards for their curriculum across the country right now!
3. She _____ you have a diamond in the rough here.
4. We _____ it's a good book, but we have determined that it could be a great book with a different ending.



Let's Practice!

You have some strong views on the subject.

Instructions: Choose the sentences that express strong opinion.

1. We feel it is a good book.
2. Generally, I would agree it is a good book.
3. I strongly believe that kids would prefer that kind of ending to the usual cookie-cutter style.
4. We are absolutely convinced that this is the right decision to go in.
5. I'm sure that we can come to some agreement.
6. There is no doubt in my mind that this book could be fantastic!
7. Here is what we were thinking.
8. Nice to meet you!
9. In fact, I have no doubt that this is the case.
10. It is a good idea to get outside of the box and try new ideas.





Extension Activity

Opinions about controversial statements.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find a controversial story in the newspaper. This could be a popular current topic in celebrity news or entertainment, the world of sports, world news or politics.
- Read the story.
- Create general statements about the topic that would encourage further discussion. (For example, if your story is about a professional football player who earns an exorbitant amount of money per game, your statement could be "Professional sportspeople should earn more money.")
- Present the story and statements in groups.
- Discuss your opinions about the stories and the statements.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I read a newspaper story.

☐ ☐

I write statements that will encourage discussion.

☐ ☐

I present my newspaper story in groups.

☐ ☐

I discuss my statements about the topic in groups.

☐ ☐

I share my opinions about the statements and the topic.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- short notice** (adjective): with little advance warning
e.g. Thank you for coming in and seeing us on such short notice.
- to plant** (verb): to put something in a place secretly
e.g. He planted seeds of doubt in the employer's mind.
- cookie-cutter style** (noun): style which is considered common or average
e.g. I strongly believe that kids would prefer that kind of ending to the familiar cookie-cutter style.
- clues** (noun): information that helps you to find the answer to a problem, question, or mystery
e.g. I feel that if you are able to tie the end of the story back to clues in the beginning, it will provide a much more positive result.
- diamond in the rough** (expression): someone or something that has hidden exceptional characteristics and/or future potential, but currently lacks refinement
e.g. We think you have a diamond in the rough here.
- What did you have in mind?** (expression): what is your plan or intention?
e.g.
Denise: I'm sure that we can come to some agreement.
Marisa: Ok. What do you have in mind?



Learning Points

Unstressed Vowels and Vowel Reduction

There are two rules:

1. One word has only one stress.
2. You do not stress consonants, only vowels.

When there is more than one vowel sound in a word, the stressed vowel says its sound and the other vowels become reduced.

For example:

Banana pronounced Buh- NA- nuh. The stressed vowel (A) is pronounced clearly, and the other vowels become reduced to the sound schwa.

Take a look at some other words. Say them aloud, saying the stressed vowel clearly and the others with a reduced sound:

deter**ter**mined
prof**ess**or
curric**u**lum
accept**ac**t
dec**is**ion

Now read these sentences from the text. Remember to pronounce the vowel sounds correctly.

Examples:

- Let me say first that your book is very interesting and extremely **important**, especially with what's going on with kids in today's technological world.
- We feel it's a good book, but we have **determined** that it could be a great book with a different ending.
- In fact, my **professor** has no doubt that this is the case.
- We feel that we could sell this book to school boards for their **curriculum** across the country right now!
- Ok. I guess I can **accept** that.
- It's the right **decision**. Here's what we were thinking.





Learning Points

Expressions for Presenting Strong Opinions

When you want to express your opinions, there are many expressions you can use. It is important to be able to communicate your opinion, however strong, in a way that is clear but also polite.

Here are some expressions for presenting a strong opinion:

I'm absolutely convinced that ...

I'm sure that ...

I strongly believe that ...

I have no doubt that ...

There's no doubt in my mind that ...

For example:

There's no doubt in my mind that this book could be fantastic!

Practice saying these sentences from the dialogue aloud:

Examples:

- *We are absolutely convinced that this is the right direction to go in.*
- *I strongly believe that kids would prefer that kind of ending to the usual cookie-cutter style.*
- *In fact, I have no doubt that this is the case.*
- *There's no doubt in my mind that this book could be fantastic!*
- *I'm sure that we can come to some agreement.*

